

Build What Moves India

Consolidated Builder Brief + FAQ

Consolidated from the official **Builder Brief** and **Frequently Asked Questions** pages.

This document preserves the substance, requirements, dates, rules, and FAQ guidance in a single structured reference.

1. Builder Brief

The Challenge

Choose one real problem you have personally faced while using an Indian public-service website or digital service, then build a version of that experience that is simpler, clearer, and more useful.

The problem may relate to areas such as:

- Travel
- Taxes
- Pensions
- Certificates
- Payments
- Grievances
- Any other public need

Services such as IRCTC, EPFO, and the Income Tax portal are examples, not a restricted list of allowed services.

What You Need to Build

The prototype submitted for the hackathon must be:

- Built using **Codex**, or
- Powered by an **OpenAI model**

Codex must play a meaningful role in the actual development process. It should not be added only for the purpose of the submission.

If a project reaches the **10-finalist stage**, OpenAI will provide support.

The prototype should solve the chosen problem through a **complete citizen journey**.

Where production access would be unsafe, restricted, or unavailable, builders should use:

- Mock data
- Mock accounts

- Simulated backend behavior
- Simulated integrations

Reviewers will evaluate the **citizen-facing experience**, not an admin dashboard.

The prototype should:

- Solve one clearly defined user problem.
- Allow the reviewer to complete the main journey from beginning to end.
- Be easier to understand or use than the current experience.
- Be designed for real Indian users.
- Work thoughtfully for mobile users, slower internet connections, and people with limited digital experience.
- Use mock or synthetic data whenever the real flow would involve personal information, payments, OTPs, or government systems.

What a Strong Build Looks Like

A strong submission should make the following clear:

1. **Who has the problem?**
2. **What is difficult about the current experience?**
3. **What has your solution changed?**
4. **Why is your approach better?**
5. **Which parts work today and which parts are mocked?**
6. **How could the idea operate safely at larger scale?**

The complete citizen journey should be demonstrated.

A static design is not sufficient. The user interface and interactions should work from start to finish.

Mocked data, dependencies, and integrations should be clearly disclosed.

What Not to Do

Do not:

- Access, test, or interfere with a live government system.
- Reverse-engineer private systems.
- Use undocumented private APIs.
- Scrape personal or restricted information.
- Use real Aadhaar numbers.
- Use real PAN details.
- Use real passwords.
- Use real OTPs.
- Use real payment details.
- Use real health information.
- Use other sensitive personal data.

- Present the prototype as an official government product.
 - Use government logos in a way that suggests an official partnership, endorsement, or approval.
 - Submit an existing old project with only minor modifications.
 - Include code, assets, or data that you do not have permission to use.
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What to Submit

Submission deadline

August 28, 2026 at 8:00 PM IST

There is **no grace period** after the form closes.

Required submission materials

1. Live public prototype

Provide a browser-accessible public link.

It must:

- Open without requesting reviewer access.
- Work directly in a browser.
- Not require reviewers to download a mobile app.
- Include mock consumer login credentials if login is required.

2. Demo video

Submit one video of **no more than two minutes**.

Suggested structure:

- **Minute 1:** Demonstrate the project from the citizen's point of view.
- **Minute 2:** Explain how you built it and why you made the key product and technical choices.

If participating as a pair, both teammates may appear in the video.

3. Project summary

Provide a summary of **under 250 words** explaining:

- What the project is.
- What problem it solves.
- Why it is better than the current solution.

4. Teammate details

If you are participating as a team of two:

- Both teammates must register.
- Each teammate must submit the other person's **registered email address**.

If you are participating alone, leave the partner-email field blank.

Final submission check

Every submitted link should work without requesting additional access.

How Builds Will Be Judged

Problem

Question: Is the project solving a real and important user problem?

Working Build

Question: Does the core user journey actually work?

Usability

Question: Is the experience simpler, clearer, and more accessible?

Product Thinking

Question: Are the product choices thoughtful and clearly explained?

End-to-End Thinking

Question: Does the solution consider backend systems, infrastructure, and operational processes rather than only redesigning the interface?

Honesty

Question: Are limitations, mocked components, data assumptions, and dependencies clearly disclosed?

What Happens Next

Selection happens in two stages after submissions close.

Builders should use the **same email address throughout the process**. Entries are tracked using that email address and cannot be moved to another address later.

Stage 1: Shortlist of 250

All submissions received by:

August 28, 2026 at 8:00 PM IST

will be reviewed by the organizing team together with OpenAI between:

August 28 and September 1, 2026

The **top 250 builds** will be shortlisted.

Everyone who submits will receive the result by email.

Not being selected for the top 250 does not necessarily mean the build was poor; the competition is expected to have a large field.

Stage 2: 250 to 10

The top 250 builders receive **one week of mentorship**.

Support includes a WhatsApp group with **five mentors** from areas including:

- Engineering
- Technology
- The OpenAI team

Builders use this period to improve and tighten their projects.

The improved build must then be resubmitted in the same submission format by:

September 7, 2026

Builders must continue to use the same registered email addresses.

Finalist announcement

The **10 finalists** will be announced between:

September 8 and September 12, 2026

The top 250 projects will also be recognized on a public page.

Finale

The finalists will present their projects in:

Bengaluru on September 12, 2026

The audience may include:

- Founders
- Creators
- Mentors
- Invited government officials

The winners will be announced on the same day.

Important note on adoption

Selection or winning does **not** guarantee that a government body will adopt or implement the project.

The initiative is intended to generate useful ideas and conversations about improving public digital experiences.

Prizes

Top 10

Each finalist receives:

- **One year of Codex Pro**
- **A Codex Micro**

Top 3

Each of the top three additionally receives:

- **A MacBook**

Winner

The winning build additionally receives:

- **A trip to San Francisco**, subject to visa approval

The winner also receives the rewards from the Top 10 and Top 3 tiers.

2. Frequently Asked Questions

Registering

Does filling out the registration form confirm my place?

No.

Registration is an **expression of interest**, not confirmation of participation.

Updates are shared through email and WhatsApp.

Do I need to be a developer?

No.

The hackathon is open to people such as:

- Developers
- Designers
- Product thinkers
- Students
- Independent builders

However, participants should be able to define the problem and build the prototype themselves.

Can I participate alone or as a team?

Yes.

You can participate:

- Solo, or
- In a team of two

For teams of two:

- Both teammates must register separately.
- Each person must use their own email address.
- Each teammate must provide the other person's registered email in the Project Submission form.

Participants must be **18 years or older**.

Scope of the Build

What exactly should I build?

Choose a specific problem within a public-service website or digital journey and create a better solution.

You may either:

- Improve one focused part of an existing experience, or
 - Rethink the broader end-to-end experience.
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Is a Figma design enough?

No.

Figma designs can be included as part of the project, but the primary citizen journey must be a **working prototype**.

Does every feature need to work?

Every feature that you **demo** must work.

If you show or discuss a feature during the finalist presentation, reviewers should be able to see it functioning rather than relying on an explanation of what it would eventually do.

Tools and Rules

Is Codex mandatory?

Yes, for the prototype submitted to this hackathon.

Codex must make a meaningful contribution to building the project.

You may use other:

- Development tools
- Frameworks
- Libraries
- Supporting technologies

Your submission should explain how Codex contributed.

If a public-service organization later decides to develop the solution further, the hackathon's Codex requirement does not restrict the technology used for that future implementation. The builder and public-service body may choose the technology best suited to the project.

If the build reaches the **10-finalist stage**, OpenAI will provide support.

Can I use other tools or libraries?

Yes.

You must:

- Have the right to use them.
 - Disclose their use in the submission.
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Can I use an existing government website as a starting point?

You may study an existing government website to understand its user problems.

However, you may not:

- Copy its source code.
- Build directly on private infrastructure.
- Reverse-engineer private systems.

The submitted prototype should be an **independent build**.

Can I connect to a live government system?

No, unless the organizers explicitly provide an approved public sandbox.

Otherwise, use:

- Mock data
 - Simulated integrations
 - Simulated backend behavior
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Can I use real user data?

No.

Use fictional or synthetic data.

Do not enter real:

- Identification numbers
 - Passwords
 - OTPs
 - Payment information
 - Sensitive personal information
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Can I use official logos?

Do not use a government or official logo in a manner that makes the prototype look official, approved, or endorsed.

The prototype should be clearly identified as an **independent hackathon prototype**.

Can I submit something I already built?

The submission should be created for this hackathon.

You may use standard:

- Starter templates
- Open-source components
- Reusable development components

provided their licences allow it.

Any such components should be clearly disclosed.

Submitting and Judging

When is the submission deadline?

August 28, 2026 at 8:00 PM IST

The submission form closes at that time.

There is **no grace period**.

What should the demo video show?

The video may be **up to two minutes** long.

Recommended structure:

- **First minute:** Demonstrate the project from the citizen's perspective.
- **Second minute:** Explain how you built it and why you made the key choices.

A public video link from services such as Loom or OBS-based hosting is acceptable.

Both teammates may present if the project is submitted by a team.

What else does the submission form require?

The form requires:

- A live public browser link.
- A project summary under 250 words.
- The registered email address of your teammate, if applicable.
- Mock consumer login credentials if the prototype requires login.

Do not submit a real password or sensitive personal information.

Will visual design alone win?

No.

Strong visual design helps, but judges will also evaluate whether:

- The problem is real.
 - The core journey works.
 - The experience is usable.
 - The solution is practical.
 - The product and technical thinking is strong.
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The Event

Will the winning builds be adopted by the government?

There is no guarantee that a winning or finalist project will be adopted.

The goal is to surface promising ideas and encourage constructive discussion about improving public digital experiences.

Is this an official government hackathon?

No.

It is an **independent builder initiative presented by Varun Mayya in partnership with OpenAI**.

Government or public-service representatives may be invited to participate, but their involvement should not be interpreted as government endorsement.

What happens if I am selected as a finalist?

Finalists will be asked to:

- Prepare a short demo.
- Participate in a filmed finale in Bengaluru on September 12, 2026.

The event is recorded rather than live-streamed.

Winners are announced on the same day.

The organizing team will contact finalists regarding:

- Technical checks
 - Rehearsal
 - Travel
 - Accommodation
 - Filming consent
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When is the finale?

The finale is planned for:

September 12, 2026 in Bengaluru

Exact information about:

- Timing
- Venue
- Preparation

will be sent directly to selected builders.

Are there prizes or Codex credits?

Yes.

All 10 finalists

- One year of Codex Pro
- A Codex Micro

Top 3

- Everything above
- A MacBook

Winner

- Everything above
 - A trip to San Francisco, subject to visa approval
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Your Data and Rights

Who can see my registration information?

Registration and submission data will be managed by **Varun Mayya's team**.

According to the FAQ, the **OpenAI team will not have access to this registration data**.

The final privacy notice is expected to explain:

- Who can access the information.
- Why the information is collected.
- When the information will be deleted.

Who owns my build?

You should submit only work that:

- You own, or
- You have permission to use.

You **retain full rights to your build**.

Where will updates be shared?

Updates will be sent through the:

- Email address used during registration.
- WhatsApp number used during registration.

Important dates and rule changes should also be reflected on the official website.

3. Key Dates at a Glance

Milestone	Date
Initial submission deadline	August 28, 2026, 8:00 PM IST
Initial review period	August 28 – September 1, 2026
Top 250 mentorship / improvement period	Following shortlist selection
Improved submission deadline for Top 250	September 7, 2026
Top 10 finalist announcements	September 8 – September 12, 2026
Bengaluru finale	September 12, 2026
Winners announced	September 12, 2026

4. Submission Checklist

- ☐ Pick one real Indian public-service problem.
 - ☐ Define the target citizen/user clearly.
 - ☐ Build a working end-to-end citizen journey.
 - ☐ Use Codex meaningfully in development.
 - ☐ Use synthetic or mock data.
 - ☐ Do not interact with live government systems.
 - ☐ Do not use real credentials, IDs, OTPs, payments, or sensitive information.
 - ☐ Clearly distinguish working functionality from mocked components.
 - ☐ Ensure every feature shown in the demo actually works.
 - ☐ Publish a browser-accessible public prototype.
 - ☐ Add mock login credentials if required.
 - ☐ Record a demo video of no more than two minutes.
 - ☐ Use approximately one minute for the citizen demo.
 - ☐ Use approximately one minute to explain the build and product choices.
 - ☐ Write a project summary under 250 words.
 - ☐ Add your teammate's registered email if participating as a pair.
 - ☐ Verify that every submitted link opens without requesting access.
 - ☐ Submit before **August 28, 2026 at 8:00 PM IST**.
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5. Judging Checklist

Before submitting, make sure the project can answer these questions convincingly:

Problem

- Is the problem real?
- Is it important enough to solve?
- Is the affected citizen clearly identified?

Working Build

- Can a reviewer complete the core journey from start to finish?
- Do all demonstrated features actually work?

Usability

- Is the new journey simpler than the existing one?
- Is the language clear?
- Is it mobile-friendly?
- Does it account for slower connections and users with lower digital familiarity?

Product Thinking

- Are the important design and product decisions intentional?
- Can you explain why you made them?

End-to-End Thinking

- Does the solution consider backend processes and infrastructure?
- Does it address operational constraints rather than only redesigning screens?

Honesty

- Are mock data and simulated integrations clearly labelled?
- Are current limitations disclosed?
- Is it clear what works today versus what would require future integration?

6. One-Line Summary

Find a real pain point in an Indian public digital service, build a working and materially better end-to-end citizen experience using Codex, demonstrate it honestly with mock data, and submit it by August 28, 2026 at 8:00 PM IST.

7. Video-Derived Reference Context

Source: [Build What Moves India: Rules & How to Participate](#) by Varun Mayya. The video is approximately 12 minutes long and was checked on August 24, 2026.

The notes below are a structured paraphrase of the video's English auto-generated transcript, with approximate timestamps. They are included as context and should not override the consolidated brief, FAQ, or any later official submission instructions.

Platforms shown in the screenshot

The video recommends starting with one of these 10 public-service platforms:

1. **IRCTC** — Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation
2. **Income Tax e-Filing Portal**
3. **CPGRAMS** — Centralised Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System
4. **GST** — Goods and Services Tax
5. **EPFO** — Employees' Provident Fund Organisation
6. **MCA** — Ministry of Corporate Affairs portal
7. **National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal**
8. **UMANG** — Unified Mobile Application for New-age Governance
9. **Parivahan Sewa**
10. **RTI** — Right to Information Online

The video says that another government website may be chosen if it is a strong fit, but using one of these 10 may make the solution easier for evaluators to understand because they are familiar with the existing journeys.

Transcript-derived notes

00:00–02:00 — What to build

- The initiative has received thousands of entries and the video explains the rules, expectations, build scope, and submission process.
- Build a comprehensive proof of concept: recreate the experience independently and use mocked data, backend behavior, and accounts.
- Supply working login credentials so reviewers can test the experience.
- Reviewers will judge the product from the citizen/end-user perspective, not from an admin-dashboard perspective.
- Prioritise ideas, interfaces, and interactions over the amount of code. Useful, distinctive ideas are encouraged, including maps, tax calculators, or chatbot-driven flows, but decorative complexity should not replace practical value.
- Keep the build focused. Participation is solo or with one partner, for a maximum team size of two.

02:00–04:00 — Identity and first submission

- Every teammate must be registered before submission.
- The registered email address is the participant's identity for forms, results, invitations, and matching. The video strongly warns against changing email addresses or losing access.
- Round-one submissions close on **August 28, 2026 at 8:00 PM IST**. The video describes the window as roughly seven days, though late registration means less build time.
- The submission has four parts:
 1. A live public browser-accessible link. A mobile app that reviewers cannot open in a browser will not count.
 2. A video of no more than two minutes: approximately one minute demonstrating the project as a citizen and one minute explaining the build and key decisions.
 3. A written explanation of what the project is and why it is better than the current solution.
 4. The partner's registered email address; solo participants may leave this blank. Partners must enter each other's email addresses.
- The video stresses that the deadline has no grace period.

04:00–06:00 — Review and mentorship

- The organisers and OpenAI team plan to review submissions between **August 28 and September 1, 2026**, selecting up to 250 projects.
- Selection is comparative and human; the video acknowledges that mistakes are possible at this scale and that individual feedback cannot be guaranteed.
- The top 250 receive approximately one week in a WhatsApp mentorship group with five mentors, including experienced engineers, credible developers, and people from the OpenAI team.
- The purpose of mentorship is to tighten the first proof of concept and improve it for the next submission.
- The round-two deadline is **September 7, 2026**, using the same submission format and the same registered email addresses for both teammates.

06:00–08:00 — Finalists and prizes

- The top 10 are expected to be announced between **September 8 and September 12, 2026**.
- The top 250 will be recognised on a public page as proof of work.
- The top 10 are invited to present in Bengaluru on **September 12, 2026** to founders, creators, mentors, and invited government officials.

- The finale is described as recorded rather than livestreamed, with winners announced the same day both at the event and online.
- Prizes described in the video:
 - Top 10: one year of Codex Pro and a Codex Micro.
 - Top 3: a MacBook in addition to the Top 10 rewards.
 - Winner: a trip to San Francisco, subject to visa approval, in addition to the other rewards.

08:00–12:03 — Purpose and adoption

- The video sets expectations that most entrants will not reach the stage because the field is large, while emphasising that reaching the top 250 is itself meaningful.
- The broader goal is to create dialogue between India's technology ecosystem, content creators, and government bodies by presenting concrete public-service prototypes.
- The organisers may surface or separately share promising ideas with public-service stakeholders, but there is no guarantee that a government body will adopt any feature or project.
- The closing message is to focus on ideas that can materially improve citizens' experiences and to use the build as a practical proof of work.

Context notes and reconciliation

- The video says the written summary should be **exactly 250 words**, while the consolidated brief and FAQ say **under 250 words**. Treat the official submission form and the latest organiser instructions as the source of truth when submitting.
- The video is guidance from the organiser, not a replacement for the rules and FAQ above. Any later official update should take precedence over these notes.